

[Return to Search](#)

Original Page: 342

Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1952-1953

Coverage Date: Ca. 1950s

Place Coverage: !Kung San, Nyae Nyae Region, Namibia

Section Title(S): Category 2: Affines

Why marriage is prohibited with HuBrSo and WiSiDa was explained by ≠Toma. Marriages with HuBr or WiSi are highly preferred marriages. This makes ≠Toma ‘feel like’ his WiSiHu, he said, even though he is not married to her, and, as a result, his WiSiDa seems to him like his own daughter.

[582](#)
[Regulation Of Marriage](#)

[602](#)
[Kin Relationships](#)

[835](#)
[Kinship Regulation Of Sex](#)

FIG. 3. *Affines*

<i>Marriage forbidden</i>	<i>Male</i>	<i>Female</i>	<i>Joking</i>
Parents of ego's spouse	≠tʊm	!utsu	} no
Spouses of FaBr, FaSi, MoBr, MoSi	tsu	!lga	
SiHuFa w.s., BrWiMo m.s.	tsu	!lga	
(Ego's generation terminologically)			
Parents of SoWi, DaHu	!umba	!undai	yes
Spouses of So and Da	≠tʊm	!utsu	} no
HuBrSo, WiSiDa	tsu	!lga	

[582](#)
[Regulation Of Marriage](#)

[601](#)
[Kinship Terminology](#)

[602](#)
[Kin Relationships](#)

[835](#)
[Kinship Regulation Of Sex](#)

Marriage with a BrWiMo or SiHuFa seems improper to the !Kung because a man's marriage with his BrWi is highly preferred, as is a woman's with a SiHu

[582](#)
[Regulation Of Marriage](#)

[587](#)

(should the death of the spouse or divorce make their marriage possible), and the parents of these affines therefore seem 'like' parents of the spouse.

Secondary Marriages

602
Kin Relationships

835
Kinship Regulation Of
Sex

In the sibling category among affines ego is prohibited from marrying only WiBrWi or HuSiHu. The reason for this prohibition appears to lie in the consistency of the joking pattern, about which three more points must be made. First, throughout

582
Regulation Of Marriage

602
Kin Relationships

835
Kinship Regulation Of
Sex

FIG. 4. Marriage forbidden with WiBrWi, HuSiHu

Male ego				Female ego			
Joking				Joking			
Br and BrWi	.	.	yes	Br and BrWi	.	.	no
Si and SiHu	.	.	no	Si and SiHu	.	.	yes
WiSi and WiSiHu	.	.	yes	HuBr and HuBrWi	.	.	yes
WiBr and WiBrWi	.	.	no	HuSi and HuSiHu	.	.	no